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Willesden Branch. Tuesday, June 25. Presenting some of the more beautiful Chazonishe Records; introduced by a well-known local Cantor. At the Willesden Synagogue Hall, Heathfield Park, N.W.2, at 8.15 p.m.

Stamford Hill Branch. Thursday, June 27. Joint Social. The Branch is host to the British Legion, R.A.F.A., and other Branches of Ajex. Dancing to Max Lewis and his Orchestra. Everyone welcome. At the Marcus Samuel Hall, Egerton Road, N.16, at 8.15 p.m.

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Sun., June 23. Social presentation. (See below.)

Wed., June 25. At 8 p.m. prompt. Dramatics announce full production casting for "Clutterbuck" or "The Shop At Sly Corner." Auditions at the above address. Vacancies still exist for specialists in scenic design and stage management. All other activities as usual.

SUNDAY, JUNE 23

A Calypso night at the **Candlelight.** Dance to Curtis and Edmundo, the West Indian singer of TV fame. 5/-. 8 p.m. J.A.C., 1, Broadhurst Gardens, N.W.6.

"A good time was had by all." That's what they said at the last dance with the **Brenthouse J.Y.C.** Better still this time. Dancing to Sidney Lennard's Orchestra from 7.30 p.m. at the Synagogue Hall, Brenthouse Road, Hackney, E.9. Prizes. Refreshments. Novelties.

Again the **Maccabi** are proud to present sensational trumpet virtuoso Monty Raymonde with his "All Stars," featuring famous trombonist Rick Kennedy, and music in the Benny Goodman style by clarinettist Jeff Carter, also the voice and piano of Peter Gray. See, hear, and dance to some of Britain's top Jazz musicians. From 7.30-11 p.m. Members 3/-. Guests 5/-. (Over-18s only.)

Golders Green & Dist. J.S. Club for Over-35s, Benmore Hall (SPE. 9460). Tonight, 7.30. Summer Social, with cabaret and refresh.

Hendon J.Y.C., Raleigh Close, N.W.4, reminds all members that tonight is our Midsummer Ball! Two bands! Skiffle & Jive! We hope! 7.30 to 10.30 p.m. Members 2/-. A.J.Y. Guests (cards) 3/-. Other Guests 3/6. Raffle!

If in Brighton this week-end, the **Brighton and Hove L.J.Y.A.** cordially invite you to its "Midsummer Revels" at the Montefiore Hall, Lansdowne Road, Hove. Dancing to Rod Beresford and his Band. 7.30 to 11.30 p.m. Admission 4/-.

Spend your Sundays outdoors with the **Senior Ramblers.** Details, Hon. Sec., 173, Brooke Road, E.5.

MONDAY, JUNE 24

Tonight's the night the **Three R's** meet to plan their Autumn Ball, which we hope to make as great a success as our Brighton "Cafe Contiental." We welcome all. Shaftesbury Hotel, Monmouth St., W.1. 8.30 p.m.

TUESDAY, JUNE 25

Hadassah welcomes all those who are interested in joining a Social & Cultural Club tonight. Have your photograph taken by Jack Jacobs, who will also demonstrate the use of lighting and the finer points of photography. Remembrance Hall, Clissold Road.

Harmony Club, 139, Upper Clapton Road, presents another of its famous Talent Competitions. Open to all. 8.30 prompt.

3 S's (Over 21's) are having a "Mixed Grill" tonight. Come along and join in the fun at the Shaftesbury Hotel, Monmouth St., W.C.2. Starting 8.30 p.m. Members 1/6. Visitors 3/-.

WEDNESDAY, JUNE 26

Harmony Club. Classical Music Section. Table Tennis in Hall.

J.A.C. Dance by Candlelight.

North Middlesex J.C. Ex-Detective Supt. R. M. Higgins will speak on "My experiences whilst at New Scotland Yard." 8.30 p.m. at New Synagogue Hall, Forty Avenue, Wembley.

THURSDAY, JUNE 27

Classic Jewish Theatre Group. Three One-Act Plays. Toynbee Hall Theatre. For further details see Forthcoming Events.

Harmony Club. "Open House." Dancing, Snooker, Table Tennis, etc.

Nomads. An Inter-Club Debate with the Medina Society. The Cranbourne, Great Newport Street, W.C.2. 8 p.m. Visitors sincerely welcome.

SUNDAY, JUNE 30

Old Brodians' Association presents a Grand Dance at its new club, Adler House, Adler Street, E.1. Al Allnatt and his Orchestra and vocalist. 7.30-11. M.C., Sid Palmer. Cabaret, spots, etc. Admission by ticket only, price 3/6, from Hon. Sec., Frank Bernard, 74, High Street, Hornsey, N.8.

Stanmore Garden Party, 25, Glanleam Road, Stanmore. Sideshows, children's amusements, tea garden, refreshments. 3 to 6.30 p.m. Adults 3/6, accompanied children 1/-. **E. & D.O.A.S. (Y.P.C.).** Followed by Barbecue Dance. 8-midnight. Fireworks, distractions. 10/6. "June," STO. 7624.

DANCE HALLS, ETC.

SUNDAY, JUNE 23

A **Blue Star Club** great opening night at beautiful new premises, the magnificent private ballroom suite of Fuller's Restaurant, 206, Regent St., W.1, side entrance at "Jaeger's" (1 min. Oxford Circus). This lovely place really has everything, a spacious ballroom with a very large floor, beautifully air-conditioned, fully lic. bar and soda fountain, a delicious refreshment bar, and a wonderful atmosphere. Dancing to popular Harry Pitch and his Orchestra. M.s & G.s 7/6. Strictly limited. At 7.30. As usual with Blue Star functions teenagers cannot be admitted.

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Bar of Music Club, 37, Oxford Street, W.1. Rock 'n' Roll to Johnny "Sugar 'n' Spice" at the [illegible]." Come and hear sensational singing [illegible] Cyril Freedman, rocking 'n' rolling. [illegible] lounge. 7.30. Admission 5/-, after 8 p.m. 5/6.

TALMIDA HACHAMA

Grammatical Form

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

SIR,—Dr. Slotki—perhaps misled by my using "means" in the sense of "means literally"—appears to have missed my point, which was surely a grammatical one. Nobody would deny that, in order to qualify for the appellation *talmid hacham*, a man must be learned himself, and not merely the pupil of a learned man; but the fact remains that the word *talmid* in the expression in question is in the construct state. If it were in the absolute state, the plural of the expression would obviously be *talmidim hachamim*, and not, as it actually is, *talmidei hachamim*. It seems to me to follow that a feminine *talmid hacham*, be she even as wise and learned as Rabbi Akiba himself, should be called *talmidat hacham*.

LEON SIMON.

"Kinnereth."
7 Briardale Gardens, N.W.3.

SIR,—The phase *talmid hacham* means neither "a sage disciple" nor "a sage's disciple." It is an idiomatic expression and as such has lost the literal meaning of its component parts and acquired a meaning entirely of its own: a scholar (learned man) of great humility (Sotah 5a) and unblemished character (Sh. Hash. Rabba 4). His erudition and memory are well-nigh phenomenal: "Who is a *Talmid Hacham*? He who can readily quote any law chapter and verse" (Shabbat 114a freely translated). But accumulation of knowledge is not enough; he must make his own intellectual contribution to the advancement of learning: "A *Talmid Hacham* who has no opinion of his own is worse than a b'hemah" (Tanna d'bei Eliyahu 86).

As to the grammar of the phrase, which is the real bone of contention between Mr. Slotki and Sir Leon Simon, I confess that not until I read Mr. Slotki's letter did I envisage the possibility of there being two opinions of the etymology of *talmid hacham*. Mr. Slotki asks for an authority for Sir Leon's assertion that the phrase consists of two nouns in the construct state. He (Mr. Slotki) is apparently unaware that he himself has supplied the authority in his quotation from Hullin: "He who . . . serves *Talmidei Hachamim*." The plural of *talmid hacham* is the only means whereby its true grammatical form can be ascertained. If these two words were, as Mr. Slotki alleges, a noun and an adjective respectively, their plural would have been *talmidim hachamim* and not *talmidei hachamim*, which proves beyond a shadow of a doubt that Sir Leon is right. Another authority, which is equally conclusive by itself, is the alternative usage of *talmid hachamim* in the same idiomatic sense as *talmid hacham* (Yerushalmi Succa 53a).

The proposed innovation of *talmida hachama* offends the ear and eye of anyone familiar with Hebrew, whereas Sir Leon's version of *talmidat hacham* is the only form true to centuries of Hebrew tradition and learning.

ZVI VARDY.

5 Essex Court,
Temple, E.C.4.

In the fourth line of Dr. Slotki's letter, published in our issue of last week, the word *Hacham* should have read *Hachama*.

CARMEL LAWN TENNIS CLUB

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Visitors welcome.

SUNDAY, JUNE 23

Club Carousel, 139, Upper Clapton Rd., E.5. We apologise for turning away potential members owing to the outstanding success of our opening night, but can only advise you to come early. Once again we are presenting in our Starlight Room the Mambo-Jive & Calypso King, Ed Nicholls & his band, featuring Kenny Lynch, leading alto sax Frank Aldrich, of Jack Parnell's Orchestra, plus the fabulous rhythm section of American and international fame, the Rhythmaires. Continuous dancing 8-11.15 p.m. Continental bar, lounge. Car park free. Members 5/-. Membership fee 2/-.

Club El Toro. The coolest Sunday Club of them all. Dance in comfort to Enrico and his Cha-Cha Orchestra. 253, Finchley Road, N.W.3. 7.30-11.30.

Club Vienna, 209, Baker Street. Dancing at your favourite rendezvous, 8-11 p.m. to Maurice Reismann & his Band. Cosmopolitan atmos. Espresso bar. 5/-. Mem. 1/-. Please come early, ensure adm.

Come to the new **Les Amis Club.** Mambo, Cha-Cha, and Jive in beautiful contemporary surroundings to Salvadore and his Mamboleros. 33, Exeter St., Aldwych, W.C.2 (adj. Lyceum). Inq.: TEM. 3871.

Celebrite (Fischer's), 17, New Bond Street, W.1. Tea Dance, 8/6. 3.30-6 p.m. Evg. Dance, 8-12 midnight. Admission 7/-. Tim-Wu-Kee Six and Robin Richmond.

Jewish Seniors Society, Gargoyle Club, 69, Dean Street, W.1. Tonight another Gala Evening on the enchanting "Roof Garden Ballroom." Dancing under the stars over the rooftops of Soho to the Continental music makers, Ray Gregory and his Music. Fully lic. cocktail lounge and coffee bar. Members 6/6, guests 7/6. (If wet, dancing in the Mirror Ballroom as usual.) Last Sunday a capacity crowd of the friendliest over-25s had a wonderful evening at Anglo-Jewry's only open-air ballroom.

Jewry's **Club Paradise** invites you into the hall of the future, the luxurious Marquee, 165, Oxford Street, W.1, where the more discerning and mature set meet in luxurious surroundings. You cannot fail to appreciate its unrivalled decor, charm, and sophisicated atmosphere. Tonight not just a band but a complete evening's entertainment, in person Mayfair's foremost vocal and multi-instrumental group, Ted Taylor and his Music. 7.30-11.30 p.m. Espresso Coffee Lounge & Buffet. Members & Guests 7/6. This dance is for the older set. Rights of admission strictly reserved.

The International Set are happy to announce that once again they have taken over the luxurious, air-conditioned "Mayfair Room" at Selby's, Hanover St., Regent St., W.1, for their fourth function. Enjoy summer dancing in the best conditions in a beautiful ballroom with modern air-conditioning, no need to stifle in those over-crowded, stuffy cellars. This "Midsummer Ball" is for the older and more discriminating set, who have made dancing at Selby's so successful. Swing & sway to the exciting and pulsating music of TV & record star Peter Ricardo and his "Musique Tropicale." We always welcome Continental & provincial visitors to meet friends, old and new, at this Mecca for discerning dancers. Ms. & Gs. 7/6. 7.30 to 11.30.

27s to 45s Sunday Club. Tonight, as usual, at the Shaftesbury Hotel, Monmouth St. Dancing to Max Lewis, in person, and his Band and Leslie Childs to welcome you. Dancing 7.30 to 11 p.m. Admission 8/6, including refreshments.

THURSDAY, JUNE 27

Club El Toro. Dance in London's coolest club, with the week-end atmosphere. 253, Finchley Road, N.W.3.

Club Vienna, 209, Baker St. Grand Dance tonight at your fav. mid-week rendezvous. Members 2/6 before 9 p.m., 3/6 after.

Hammersmith Palais. Twice daily, 3 & 7.30. Lou Preager Orchestra, Phil Tate Orch. June 24, 7.45 till 12. Second Cats Nite Out. 10 bands. Skiffle, Rock 'n' Roll, Trad.

GOOD RELATIONS

Activities of Zionist Federation

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

SIR,—If the object of your leading article, "Good Relations" (in your June 7 issue), is to have the effect desired it must also reflect more fully and accurately the present *modus operandi* used in the struggle for the creation of good relationship between Israel and Britain.

In the course of your analysis you say "a serious deficiency at present is the lack of a lecture bureau in London that could supply lecturers for provincial organisations . . . *not* for fund-raising purposes. . . . There is a constant flow of lecturers from Israel . . . but there is no machinery . . . for linking them with provincial audiences." Yet a glance at the columns of your esteemed journal shows that an efficient machinery already exists in London for this purpose, organised by the Central Jewish Lecture Committee which co-ordinates lectures on Israel with the Public Relations Committee of the Zionist Federation. No audience, either Jewish or non-Jewish, has gone wanting for a speaker on the subject of Israel, and within my knowledge there has never yet arisen the problem of "expenses" or "fee."

Since "Sinai" (October, 1956) the Federation alone has provided speakers for 115 non-Jewish organisations, both large and small, and well over 50 per cent of them in the provinces. Apart from moments of crisis, the Federation, through the affiliated bodies in the provinces, is in constant contact with local societies and no opportunity is lost for organising provincial tours for eminent lecturers from Israel.

While it is not a central point in your theme, there exists an implication that films on Israel are distributed "spasmodically and without much co-ordination." Your readers might like to know that since March, 1956, the Federation has regularly published, with the assistance of other interested organisations, a comprehensive catalogue of Israeli films and other audio-visual material, so that a potential borrower is not put to undue trouble.

The systematic development of friendly relations between Israel and Britain and the promotion of Israeli culture in Britain is the main concern of the Zionist Federation's Public Relations Committee. The Committee, under the Chairmanship of Mr. Barnett Janner, M.P., and the Vice-Chairmanship of Miss B. J. Barwell, maintains constant contact with the press; initiates letters to the press on Zionist-Israeli issues and answers hostile letters; maintains contact with those centres of informed opinion—the universities and with the creators of popular opinion—sound radio and television; keeps its Zionist circles in the provinces and London fully *au fait* with the latest position in Israel; organises annually (this year 500) film shows for non-Jewish and Jewish organisations both in London and the provinces; provides speakers for innumerable local bodies such as Rotary Clubs, Women's Institutes, and political groups, and provides speakers also for many week-end conferences on the Middle East arranged by various organisations, so that the case of Israel is adequately represented; the Committee also has the task of counteracting the propaganda of many of the Arab Embassies in London which is being circulated in the universities.

I have referred at length to these activities of the Zionist Federation in order to show that the development of public opinion in Israel's favour is a continuous and scientific process. No one engaged in this work can afford to be lethargic or rest on his laurels. Much is being done, much more can be done. THE JEWISH CHRONICLE is to be complimented for focusing attention on this matter and for advancing a number of excellent suggestions. In this the Zionist Federation is prepared to play its part.

MONTY SCHAFFER,
Public Relations Officer.

77 Great Russell Street,
London, W.C.1.

MR. M. PELED, Assistant Economic Counsellor to the Israeli Embassy, discussed the situation in Israel after the Sinai campaign at a meeting of the Stamford Hill branch of Ajex, at the Marcus Samuel Hall, Egerton Road, recently.

HILLEL HOUSE

To be Closed for Three Months

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

SIR,—The many hundreds of students from home and overseas who use Hillel House regularly are informed that major building repairs make it necessary for this centre to close for three months on July 1.

Thanks to the friendly understanding of our difficulties shown by the Women's First Lodge of the B'nai B'rith, the United Synagogue, and Jews' College, certain limited facilities will be available for students in Woburn House during this period.

The office of the Foundation will be housed temporarily on the sixth floor of Woburn House, where our usual student service for personal help and accommodation will continue. A common room will be provided, and rooms will be available for the several grades of Hebrew classes and lectures which are such a prominent feature in the student programme of Hillel House. Full details will be published for their members by the London Jewish Students' Association and the University of London Jewish Union Society. College notice boards will also have detailed information displayed.

Unfortunately, it has been impossible to arrange alternative dormitory accommodation or any kind of regular meals service during the next three months, nor have we been able to make any provision for a continuance of the Onegei Shabbat which attracted so many thousands of students and graduates from all parts of the world to Hillel House during the past two and a half years.

However, for those young men and women who would like Sabbath hospitality in private homes, every effort will be made to introduce them to suitable families, and I would invite them to get in touch with me at the Foundation's temporary office.

The new College year begins on or about October 1, by which time a repaired and renovated Hillel House will be ready to receive all old friends as well as Freshmen from whichever part of the country they come. Perhaps, indeed, during this interval we might even find a much-needed larger building for our activities.

HENRY SHAW,
Director.

Hillel House,
1 Endsleigh Street, W.C.1.

EDUCATION IN ISRAEL

Overcrowded Classes Danger

To the Editor of THE JEWISH CHRONICLE

SIR,—Some considerable time elapsed between the writing of my article on "Israel's Educational Crisis" and its publication in your June 7 issue. Meanwhile, there have been further developments in the field of Israel's secondary education which make it necessary to rectify certain points raised in the article in order to bring it up-to-date.

The findings of the Zeltner Committee on secondary education have been published and in principle accepted by the Ministry of Education.

The Committee's recommendations are, *inter alia*:

(1) The Ministry of Education and the local authorities throughout Israel are to bear 40 per cent of the cost of secondary education, the remaining 60 per cent is to be shouldered by the parents of the pupils.

(2) Henceforth, the maximum fee to be charged at secondary schools is I£360 per annum per pupil.

(3) Only such grammar-school pupils whose intelligence and aptitude are found suitable for studies of an academic bias are to be helped out of public funds.

The Ministry of Education has accepted these recommendations *in toto*, though, as far as the coming school year is concerned (1957-58), only pupils of the first form of secondary schools (age group 14 to 15) will pay reduced fees.

As soon as these recommendations are fully implemented, the burden of financing secondary education, which has so far been borne by the parents alone, will be considerably lessened. At the same time, Israel's secondary education will become increasingly selective.

It must, however, be pointed out that:

(1) The recommendations of the Zeltner Committee fall short of the original Government plan for secondary education, which seems to have envisaged free secondary education for all.

(2) According to the financial computations of the Zeltner Committee the payment of the maximum fee of I£360 per pupil will make a class self-supporting only if it comprises at least 38 pupils. As headmasters may wish to raise the income of their schools above "subsistence level" it may be assumed that they will accept up to 40 and even more pupils per class. The advantage of increased selectivity may thus be offset by the disadvantages of overcrowded classes.

(Dr.) Z. E. KURZWEIL.

4 Aaron Lane,
Ahuza, Haifa.

THE East Ham, Manor Park, and Ilford Synagogue Ladies' Charity Guild organised a jumble sale recently at which £32 was raised for charities.

Points from Letters

YOUNG NEWLY-WEDS CLUB

The attention of your readers in the Forest Gate area is drawn to the fact that there is a Young Married Couples Club named The Thursday Nighters which meets, in the synagogue, Earlham Grove, every Thursday night. We now have room for a few more members, and if any reader is curious to know what it is all about—a telephone call to me at Maryland 5095 will bring all the information wanted.—A. FREEMAN, Hon. Secretary, 31 Knox Road, Forest Gate, E.7.

AIDING HANDICAPPED CHILDREN

"The Knights of Charity" are raising funds for three organisations concerned with the welfare of handicapped children. They are the Manchester and District School for Jewish Handicapped Children, the Eccles and District Society for Mentally Handicapped Children, and the Handicapped Children's Hostel, Grange Over Sands. Donations to these worthy causes should be addressed to Miss E. Silverman, 34 Scholes Lane, Prestwich.—C. GOTTLIEB, Publicity Officer, 19 Breeze Mount, Prestwich, Lancs.

COMMANDER KENNETH COHEN, C.B., C.M.G., is to be the new Hon. Secretary of the Franco-British Society.

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About Books

REMBRANDT AND SPINOZA

Rembrandt and Spinoza. A Study of the Spiritual Conflicts in Seventeenth-Century Holland. By W. R. VALENTINER. *Phaidon Press.* 21s.

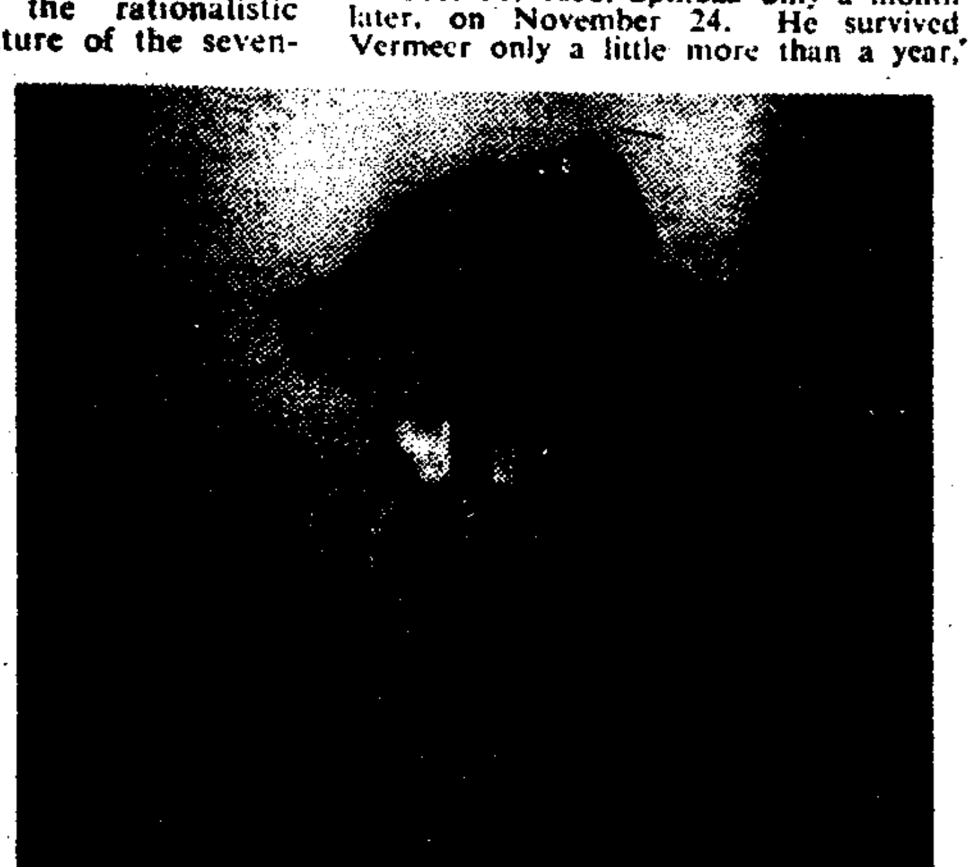
Reviewed by LEON ROTH

Mr. Valentiner's book is an essay in the "feel" of history. It seeks to show that creative minds manifest currents which are flowing in the spiritual tide of the age; and as examples of this thesis, after a preliminary glance at Descartes and Franz Hals, it settles down to a comparative study of Rembrandt and Spinoza. Spinoza represents in Mr. Valentiner's view the rationalistic trend in Dutch culture of the seventeenth century, Rembrandt the intuitive; and the comparison between them is pursued in a series of interesting essays illustrated by reproductions of contemporary works of art. The last chapters draw some general conclusions and, after contrasting Rembrandt and Vermeer, discuss the uniqueness and value of genius.

Mr. Valentiner's thesis, when taken lightly, is suggestive, and gives the reader an opportunity of reviewing some old facts in a new light. The trouble is that Mr. Valentiner seems at times to lay too much stress on it and to treat it, not as a loose descriptive formula in the tradition of Hazlitt's enlightening "Spirit of the Age," but as an articulation of historical necessity. It is inetrsting to note, for example, that Leeuwenhoek (the microscopologist) was born and baptised in Delft on the same day as Vermeer; but is that really evidence "how closely these creators of a new mathematical age were connected with the artists in the different cities of the Netherland"?

The year 1656 saw both Spinoza's excommunication and Rembrandt's bankruptcy, and Mr. Valentiner regards this as no more than a curious coincidence. But what are we to make of this (the italics are mine):

"In all these other fields we encounter the same phenomenon—that the individual creators *had to be fitted into the great epoch* regardless of the span of their lives. Thus Spinoza, born in the same year as Vermeer, created his greatest works in his youth and *had to die young*. Vermeer was born on October 31, 1632, Spinoza only a month later, on November 24. He survived Vermeer only a little more than a year, passing away at the age of forty-four on February 22, 1677, while Vermeer died on December 15, 1675, reaching an age of only forty-three." (Page 79.)



Rembrandt: Portrait of a young Jewish student (Spinoza?)

The facts are facts and Mr. Valentiner's explanation of them may be, for all I know, true. But I submit that there is, and can be, no evidence for it. It is a statement of the type which can be denied as easily as it can be affirmed, and it is therefore (to speak gently) unhelpful. And it is throwing a serious responsibility on a theory to make it cut short men's lives.

Rival Philosophies

On this major point, therefore, Mr. Valentiner and I would seem to disagree; and I should ask him, further, to consider whether the opposition between rationalism and intuition he so much relies on is a real one. Is it not rather the fact that it is just Spinoza who (after Plato) gave the classical account of the passing of the one into the other? And I might go on to inquire whether Spinoza's "rationalistic" ideas are indeed so foreign to the primacy of emotion signalled out by Mr. Valentiner as being the distinguishing characteristic of Rembrandt. He should recall that it was just the Romantics among the Germans who rediscovered and almost divinised Spinoza; and understandably, because it was Spinoza who insisted that the salvation of man lies not in obliterating emotion (which is impossible) but in finding its proper object.

Again, it was Spinoza who said that the more we know individual things, the more we know God; and it was this saying of Spinoza which, together with the famous "He who loves God should not strive that God should love him in return," was venerated by Goethe. In these two sayings we have surely the basis of the world-view which is attributed by Mr. Valentiner to Rembrandt and which would seem to be expressed in the combination of particularity and infinity which characterises the most famous of Rembrandt's paintings. I do not say that this suggestion is any more, or any less, valid than Mr. Valentiner's. I only say that the subject as such is too tenuous for the basing on it of confident conclusions.

Continued in next column

Continued from previous column

Mr. Valentiner is to be congratulated on having assembled for our delight and instruction so many examples of the painters' and etchers' art. But the last word goes to the Phaidon Press for its never-to-be-sufficiently-admired beauty of design which covers here, as always, binding, typography and page-setting, as well as reproduction of plates. One could have wished them in colour but, as Aristotle said long ago, perfection is not for mortals. But why, O why, did not Mr. Valentiner ask them to reproduce the miniature first published by Schaarschmidt nearly a hundred years ago, and which shows Spinoza not as the rarefied scholar-saint of the Wolfenbüttel portrait but as the olive-complexioned, curved-nosed, round-faced Sephardi youth he is credibly reported to have been? I fear that in matters of Spinoza scholarship (on this as on other points) Mr. Valentiner did not always find the right guides.

LAND OF PROMISE

The Last Temptation. By JOSEPH VIERTEL. *Hammond and Hammond.* 16s.

Reviewed by MEIR GILLON

Considered purely as fiction "The Last Temptation" is excellent, can't-put-it-down reading. Debbie and Victor Marmorek, assimilated Jews from Vienna and Czechoslovakia, arrive off the shores of Mandated Palestine in a "hell-ship" at the height of the post-war "illegal" immigration. The story of their integration into the Promised Land, of Victor's settling down in a British Government department and his relationships with his Jewish colleagues and British superiors, are excellently done. The appalling experiences of the couple during the Jerusalem siege carry the story to dramatic heights; although it is a pity that Mr. Viertel had to alter the background and detail of the famous Hagana Treason Court Martial, which is a case when truth is infinitely more convincing than fiction.

But the trouble with "documentary" novels is that they are apt to be judged on two levels—as fiction and as history. For anyone familiar with Mandated Palestine and its evolution into the State of Israel, "The Last Temptation" has irritating minor inaccuracies.

The Immigrants

This is a great pity, because characterisation and story are extremely good. Debbie's sheltered Viennese childhood and her hunted life in wartime Rome come through more convincingly, perhaps, than her years in Jerusalem, possibly because the minor characters—her father, her mother, the Italian who befriends them in Rome—are more clear-cut than those later in the book. Debbie herself, pretty, silly, ineffectual and charming, is very real, and her growth into maturity under stress is very well done. Her son David is a little boy to remember, but Victor, seen entirely through his wife's adoring eyes, is less alive.

Mr. Viertel's Palestine, and later Israel, are essentially those of the post-1933 immigrant from Central Europe. Sabras, "old Yishuv," British, and Arabs are misty background, somehow equally faintly hostile in all cases; no doubt, to the character of the book, that is how the rest of the country would have appeared. "The Last Temptation" is a very readable novel about a few individuals and the problems set them by life in the Jewish National Home; within its limited canvas it is excellent. Those who are still waiting for an Israeli epic on the scale of Tolstoy or Ehrenburg or Dickens can only go on hoping; it is early days yet.

BRITAIN AND ISRAEL

British Traditions in the Administration of Israel. By EDWIN SAMUEL. With a Foreword by H.E. the Israeli Ambassador. Published for the *Anglo-Israel Association* by *Vallentine, Mitchell.* 5s.

Reviewed by Professor L. F. RUSHBROOK WILLIAMS

When the writer of this notice was in Israel a short while ago, several of his friends remarked, half jokingly and half seriously, that they must now set to and learn French. It is true, indeed, that many Israelis believe that France is showing today a juster appreciation of Israel's immediate needs and future potentiality than can be discerned, even by the friendliest eye, in current British policy. In such a situation, this essay is particularly timely; for it is good that the peoples of Britain and Israel should be reminded of the fact that in a very real sense the State of Israel is the tangible result of a partnership between them. In spite of all the friction between Zionist nationalism and British conservatism which marked the closing years of the Mandate, the Israeli Ambassador is fully justified in remarking, in the course of his admirable foreword, that it was the thirty years of the Mandatory period which exercised the most important influence, alike on the Yishuv's constitutional concepts, and on the instruments it developed for their implementation. As the present writer noticed in the course of his visits to Israel, it is far easier for an Englishman to understand the structure and working of the State of Israel than it is for any other foreigner.

Two Traditions

No one is better qualified to write an essay of this kind than Mr. Edwin Samuel. As Mr. Elath rightly says, he personifies all that is best in the gifts which England has given to Israel: loyalty to the land of his birth, and full understanding of, and devotion to, the ideals of the Jewish National home. He brings to his task an intimate appreciation of the value of what is best in both national traditions, and a keen perception of the help which British practice can supply to Israel in fulfilling the practical, concrete tasks of good government. It is heartening to think that the tradition of service which Mr. Edwin Samuel shares with his distinguished father, Lord Samuel, has been handed on to the third generation. Mr. Edwin Samuel's son is now working in the Weizmann Institute of Science.

This essay is essential reading for everyone who wishes to understand, and to strengthen, the tie which links Britain and Israel, not only in a shared interest in the peaceful progress of the Middle East, but in an outlook upon world affairs which has so many fundamental elements in common. Mr. Samuel traces the British influence both in the law, the Parliamentary system, and the administrative structure of Israel, and also in the growth of toleration, of a broader outlook, of a maturity of political thinking. What he writes is always wise and not infrequently witty; he carries his learning lightly, and even the least instructed of his readers can follow him without effort. There is much in these pages which, in the present writer's experience, is not to be found in any other book on Israel—certainly not in one of such compactness. So valuable is it to the student as well as to the ordinary citizen, both British and Israeli, that it well deserves an index, although it is only fifty pages long.

BOOK BRIEFS

History of Religions, by E. O. James (English Universities Press, 7s. 6d.), provides, by an authority on the subject, a useful, though necessarily sketchy, account of the development of religion from its primitive forms to the organised faiths of the ancient and modern world. Judaism is treated separately from the religion of the Hebrews as the offspring of the Babylonian exile under the influence of Zoroastrianism.

Psychiatric Studies, by C. G. Jung (Routledge and Kegan Paul, 25s.), comprises papers which appeared between 1902 and 1905 and forms vol. I of the collected works. The volume opens with Jung's dissertation for the medical degree, which was first translated into English forty years ago by M. D. Eder. There are several references to the early researches of Sigmund Freud and Josef Breuer.

The Story of Bournemouth, by David S. Young (Robert Hale, 24s.), describes the remarkable growth of a great seaside resort that began its existence only during the last century.

The Young Lions, by Irwin Shaw (Pan Books, 3s. 6d.), is a reprint of this memorable novel of the last war, which has Noah Ackerman, the American Jewish soldier, as a principal character.

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